Naunas.

BUSINESS IS SIMPLE. IT'S JUST LONG.

The Leak Map

The 8 places a business with big clients quietly loses them, between the first time someone sees your work and the referral after the job is done.

● Where it leaks ☐ What to do

01

SEEN YOUR WORK

Attention

THE LEAK

They see your work, then nowhere obvious to go.

DO THIS

One link everywhere with one next step, tagged by source. Comment-keyword DMs.

Tools Google Business Profile · ManyChat · link tags

97% read reviews before choosing a local business
BrightLocal, 2026

02

THEY ENQUIRE

Capture

THE LEAK

The enquiry waits for a reply.

DO THIS

Instant auto-reply with a booking link, alert to you, personal reply in 5 minutes.

Tools Tally / your form · Cal.com · Zapier / Make

23% of companies never replied to a web enquiry
Harvard Business Review, 2011

03

IT LANDS SOMEWHERE

Pipeline

THE LEAK

Enquiries scattered everywhere.

DO THIS

Every enquiry in one list: stages, an owner, nothing "New" over 24 hours.

Tools Google Sheet / HubSpot free · Meta inbox

42 hrs average first reply to a web enquiry
Harvard Business Review, 2011

04

THEY BOOK A CALL

Follow-up

THE LEAK

No-shows and forgotten maybes.

DO THIS

Reminders 24h and 1h before, rebook link on no-shows, 14 days of follow-up.

Tools Cal.com / Calendly · MailerLite / Brevo

21× likelier to qualify replying in 5 min vs 30
Lead Response Management Study, 2007

05

THEY SAY YES

Conversion

THE LEAK

"Loved the proposal", then weeks of chasing.

DO THIS

Proposal within 48h. Read, sign and pay the deposit in one link.

Tools Stripe Payment Links · HoneyBook · PandaDoc

1.4× faster payment with an online pay option
Intuit QuickBooks data, 2025

06

THE WORK STARTS

Fulfilment

THE LEAK

Onboarding by hand, "what happens next?"

DO THIS

The deposit triggers contract, welcome, portal and next steps.

Tools Stripe + Zapier · Notion / Drive · Dubsado

60% of work time goes on chasing, updates and switching apps
Asana Anatomy of Work, 2021

07

THE JOB IS DONE

Retention

THE LEAK

The handover ends with an invoice.

DO THIS

Review ask at the high point, referral ask 2 weeks later, check-ins.

Tools Google review link · MailerLite / Brevo

25–95% more profit from keeping 5% more clients
Bain & Company, via HBR

08

ACROSS ALL OF IT

Attribution

THE LEAK

No idea which source brings the big clients.

DO THIS

Source on every enquiry, carried to the invoice. Monthly report.

Tools Link tags · GA4 · Looker Studio

Example 20 enquiries a month × $30k a client = $600k of decisions made on a guess

Score each layer **0, 1 or 2**. Your lowest score is where to start. Every layer is broken down step by step on the pages that follow.

Free audit: naunas.co.uk/audit
Naufal · contact@naunas.co.uk

BEFORE YOU START

How to use this

Every business that sells big projects runs on the same eight steps. Someone sees your work, gets in touch, lands somewhere, gets followed up, says yes, gets looked after, finishes happy and sends the next one. And something tells you which of those steps actually brought them.

Most businesses are great at the work and leak in between those steps. Not because anyone's lazy. Because each step depends on someone remembering.

For each layer you'll find:

01 **The leak** and **what it costs you**, with a line to work out your own number.

02 **Test yourself today:** a 5-minute check.

03 **Your score:** exact rules for 0, 1 or 2.

04 **Do this:** the steps, in order, with timings.

05 **Scripts:** wording you can copy.

06 **Tools** at three levels: start free, all-in-one, done for you.

07 **Common mistakes.**

08 **If you only do one thing.**

09 **The number to watch** and a recommended target.

10 **How it looks in your industry**, and proof from a real build.

Score every layer as you go. Your lowest score is where your money is leaking fastest.

01

SEEN YOUR WORK

Attention

They see your work, then nowhere obvious to go

THE LEAK

Someone finds your work through Instagram, a referral or a project you posted. They like it. Then they look for the next step and find three links, a "DM us" and a contact page that asks for their life story. So they save the post and forget.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

People who were interested but never got in touch.

Your number: visitors to your profile or site a month ____ × the share who'd have enquired with one clear step (try 1%) ____ × what a client is worth $____ = **$____ a month you never hear about.**

THE RESEARCH

97% of consumers read reviews before choosing a local business (BrightLocal Local Consumer Review Survey, 2026).

TEST YOURSELF TODAY

Open your Instagram bio and your website on your phone, as a stranger. Count the taps to send you an enquiry. Then ask: could a stranger tell in 5 seconds what you do and what to do next?

YOUR SCORE

0	No clear next step, or several competing links. No idea where enquiries come from.
1	One clear next step on some channels; Google profile exists but is thin.
2	One link with one next step everywhere, each tagged by source; Google profile current with recent reviews; posts turn comments into conversations.

DO THIS

01 Choose **one** next step for every channel: book a call, or send an enquiry. Not both, not three.

02 Put **one link** everywhere: Instagram bio, email signature, LinkedIn, Google Business Profile, quotes and invoices.

03 Add a **source tag** to each copy of the link (`yoursite.com/start?src=instagram`, `?src=google`…). Layer 08 depends on it.

04 Add a **comment keyword** to posts: "Comment PLAN and I'll send you our process", which sends an automatic DM with the link.

05 Keep your **Google Business Profile** current: photos of recent work, hours, and a steady trickle of reviews (layer 07 feeds this).

01

ATTENTION • CONTINUED

Copy it, tool it, measure it

SCRIPTS TO COPY

BIO LINE

"We design and deliver [what you do] for [who]. Start here ↓" + one link.

COMMENT-KEYWORD DM

"Hey {first name}, thanks for asking! Here's how we work and how to get started: {link}. Any questions, just reply here."

TOOLS, THREE WAYS

START FREE

A page on your own site (or a link-in-bio page) • Google's Campaign URL Builder for source tags • Google Business Profile • ManyChat (free plan) for comment-to-DM.

ALL-IN-ONE

GoHighLevel (link pages, DM automation, reviews).

DONE FOR YOU

One landing page per channel, tagged links and DM automation, all feeding your pipeline.

COMMON MISTAKES

- A link page with eight buttons: every extra choice loses people.
- Sending people to your homepage instead of a page with one job.
- Untagged links, so you never learn which channel works.

IF YOU ONLY DO ONE THING

Replace your bio link with one page that has one button.

THE NUMBER TO WATCH

Enquiries per 100 profile or site visits

RECOMMENDED TARGET

Going up month on month; measure your baseline first.

IN YOUR INDUSTRY

DESIGN STUDIOS

Your portfolio is the attention; add a "Start a project" button to every project page.

PROPERTY

Listings and investor content should end in one "book a viewing / investor call" step.

ACADEMIES

Free content should lead to one waitlist or application page.

AGENCIES

Case studies should end in one "get a proposal" step, not "contact us".

FROM A REAL BUILD

A community-events organiser in Oxford ran sign-ups through DMs and QR-code flyers. We replaced it with one events site and a sign-up flow the organisers run themselves. Founder at launch: "We are so live."

HOW THE AUTOMATION RUNS

WHEN Someone comments PLAN on a post → **THEN** Automatic DM with your link → **THEN** Tagged landing page, one next step → **RESULT** Enquiry saved with its source

THEY ENQUIRE

02 Capture

The enquiry waits for a reply

THE LEAK

Someone fills in your form at 9pm. You see it at 10am and reply at lunch. By then they've had two other replies and booked a call with whoever answered first.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Your number: enquiries a month ____ × the share lost to slow replies (be honest: 10%? 20%?) ____ × what a client is worth $____ = **$____ a month.**

THE RESEARCH

23% of companies never replied to a web enquiry at all; the average first reply took 42 hours (Harvard Business Review, 2011). Replying within 5 minutes made a lead 21 times more likely to qualify than replying at 30 minutes (Lead Response Management Study, 2007).

TEST YOURSELF TODAY

From your phone, fill in your own enquiry form with a personal email. Start a timer. When does a reply arrive, and does it tell you what happens next?

YOUR SCORE

0	Next day or later, or it depends who's around.
1	Same day, written by hand.
2	Automatic reply within a minute with a booking link, you alerted instantly, and a personal reply within 5 minutes in working hours.

DO THIS

01 **One form, 4—6 questions:** what they need, rough budget or value, timeline, location if it matters, how they heard about you.

02 **0 minutes:** an automatic reply to them: thanks, what happens next, a link to book a call.

03 **0 minutes:** an alert to you, on your phone.

04 **Within 5 minutes (working hours):** a short personal reply from a real person.

05 **24 hours with no booking:** one personal follow-up.

06 **Phone:** a voicemail that points to the booking link; if budget allows, an automatic text-back on missed calls (with permission, see page 22).

02

CAPTURE • CONTINUED

Copy it, tool it, measure it

SCRIPTS TO COPY

AUTOMATIC REPLY

"Hi {first name}, thanks for getting in touch about {project}. Here's what happens next: I'll look at your details today, and if you'd like to talk it through sooner you can pick a time here: {link}. Speak soon, {your name}"

5-MINUTE PERSONAL REPLY

"Hi {first name}, {your name} here. Just read your note about {detail they mentioned}. That's very doable. The best next step is a 20-minute call so I can understand the space and the budget. Does {day} or {day} work, or grab a time here: {link}"

24-HOUR FOLLOW-UP

"Hi {first name}, quick nudge in case my last message got buried. Still keen to help with {project}. Here's the link if it's easier: {link}"

VOICEMAIL

"You've reached {business}. We're probably on site. The fastest way to reach us is the booking link on our website, or leave your name and number and we'll call back today."

TOOLS, THREE WAYS

START FREE	ALL-IN-ONE	DONE FOR YOU
Tally or Google Forms (or your website's form) • Cal.com or Calendly free plan • the form's own email notification, or Zapier / Make / n8n for the auto-reply and alert.	GoHighLevel, HubSpot. Missed-call text-back usually needs a paid phone tool (e.g. OpenPhone, GoHighLevel).	Form, instant reply, alert and booking connected, with every enquiry landing in your pipeline automatically.

COMMON MISTAKES

- A 15-field form. Ask the minimum now, the rest on the call.
- An auto-reply that says "we'll be in touch" with no next step.
- Alerts going to an inbox nobody checks after 6pm.

IF YOU ONLY DO ONE THING

Turn on an automatic reply that includes your booking link, today.

THE NUMBER TO WATCH

Time to first reply

RECOMMENDED TARGET

Automatic reply under 1 minute; personal reply under 5 minutes in working hours.

IN YOUR INDUSTRY

DESIGN STUDIOS	PROPERTY	ACADEMIES	AGENCIES
Ask budget band and timeline up front; it saves a wasted call.	Investors expect speed; the first firm to call usually gets the meeting.	Applicants decide fast; reply while they're still on your site.	Include a calendar link in the first reply; decision-makers don't want back-and-forth.

FROM A REAL BUILD

A cleaning company quoted everything by phone. We built online pricing by home size with booking and payment up front. Co-founder on the walkthrough: "It reminds me of booking a flight."

HOW THE AUTOMATION RUNS

WHEN: Form submitted → THEN: Auto-reply with booking link (0 min) → THEN: Alert to your phone (0 min) → RESULT: No booking after 24h: personal follow-up

IT LANDS SOMEWHERE

03 Pipeline

Enquiries scattered everywhere

THE LEAK

One enquiry by DM, one by email, one from a missed call, one from a dinner party. Each lives somewhere different and nobody owns it. Two weeks later: "did we ever get back to that couple about the kitchen?"

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Your number: enquiries that went quiet last quarter with no decision either way ____ × your usual win rate ____% × what a client is worth $____ = **$____ lost to "we forgot".**

THE RESEARCH

The average first reply to a web enquiry took 42 hours (Harvard Business Review, 2011).

TEST YOURSELF TODAY

List every place an enquiry reached you in the last 30 days. Most owners find four or five. Then ask: for each, could anyone on your team say its status in 10 seconds?

YOUR SCORE

0	Enquiries live in inboxes and memory.
1	A list exists but isn't kept up to date, or some channels never reach it.
2	Every enquiry in one list, a stage and owner on each, nothing in "New" over 24 hours, reviewed weekly.

DO THIS

01 Send **every** enquiry into one list: forms automatically; DMs and calls added by hand in 30 seconds.

02 Use fixed **stages:** New → Contacted → Call booked → Proposal sent → Won / Lost (with a reason).

03 Give each enquiry **one owner.**

04 **Rule:** nothing sits in "New" for more than 24 hours.

05 **Weekly 15-minute review:** move anything stuck forward, or close it with a reason.

06 Put Instagram and Facebook messages in **one inbox**.

03

PIPELINE • CONTINUED

Copy it, tool it, measure it

SCRIPTS TO COPY

CLOSING THE LOOP (LOST / GONE QUIET)

"Hi {first name}, I haven't heard back so I'll assume the timing isn't right, and that's completely fine. I'll close this off for now. If anything changes, just reply to this and we'll pick it up."

WEEKLY REVIEW CHECKLIST

Anything in New over 24h? • Anything in Proposal sent over 7 days? • Every Lost has a reason? • Which source brought this week's enquiries?

TOOLS, THREE WAYS

START FREE	ALL-IN-ONE	DONE FOR YOU
A shared Google Sheet with those columns, or HubSpot's free CRM • Meta Business Suite (one inbox for Instagram and Facebook) • Zapier / Make to push form entries in.	GoHighLevel, HubSpot, Pipedrive. Creative studios: HoneyBook / Dubsado include a pipeline.	One pipeline every channel feeds automatically, with alerts when anything goes stale.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Too many stages. Six is plenty.
- No "Lost reason", so you never learn why.
- A CRM nobody opens because it's harder than the inbox.

IF YOU ONLY DO ONE THING

Start a sheet with Name • Source • Stage • Owner • Next step • Date, and put this month's enquiries in it.

THE NUMBER TO WATCH

Enquiries in "New" for more than 24 hours

RECOMMENDED TARGET

Zero.

IN YOUR INDUSTRY

DESIGN STUDIOS	PROPERTY	ACADEMIES	AGENCIES
Add a "Site visit booked" stage.	Separate buyers, sellers and investors; their next steps differ.	Stages run Applied → Interview → Offer → Enrolled.	Track proposal value per deal so the pipeline shows real money.

FROM A REAL BUILD

The cleaning company's admin view shows every booking moving from request to assigned job to done, with cleaners chosen by who actually works that day. Co-founder: "That gives us better options of different cleaners. That's cold, that is cold."

HOW THE AUTOMATION RUNS

WHEN Enquiry from any channel → **THEN** Added to one list as New → **THEN** Owner assigned → **RESULT** New for 24h: nudge to the owner

THEY BOOK A CALL

04 Follow-up

No-shows and forgotten maybes

THE LEAK

Two quiet leaks. Calls that get booked and nobody turns up. And people who were interested but never booked, who simply get forgotten.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Your number: booked calls a month that no-show ____ + interested people who never booked ____ = ____ × your win rate ____% × what a client is worth $____ = **$____ a month.**

THE RESEARCH

Replying within an hour made a lead about 7 times more likely to qualify than replying an hour later (Harvard Business Review, 2011). Speed matters at every touch, not just the first.

TEST YOURSELF TODAY

Book a call with yourself using your own booking link. Read the confirmation and reminders as a stranger. Do they say what the call is for and how to rebook?

YOUR SCORE

0	No reminders; no-shows aren't followed up; people who don't book are never contacted again.
1	Booking tool reminders, but no rebook message and no follow-up for people who didn't book.
2	Clear confirmation, 24h and 1h reminders, rebook within 15 minutes of a no-show, and a 14-day follow-up for people who didn't book.

DO THIS

01 **On booking:** a confirmation that says what the call covers and what to have ready.

02 **24 hours before** and **1 hour before:** reminders (email; text only with permission).

03 **No-show:** within 15 minutes, a friendly message with a rebook link.

04 **Interested, never booked:** 4—5 short, useful emails over 14 days, then a monthly check-in.

05 **Stop everything** the moment they book or reply.

04

FOLLOW-UP • CONTINUED

Copy it, tool it, measure it

SCRIPTS TO COPY

CONFIRMATION

"You're booked for {day, time}. On the call we'll go through {what they asked about}, look at your timeline and budget, and I'll tell you honestly whether we're the right fit. If you have photos or plans, bring them."

1-HOUR REMINDER

"See you at {time}. Here's the link: {link}. Need to move it? {rebook link}"

NO-SHOW

"Hi {first name}, looks like today didn't work out, no problem at all. Here's a link to grab another time that suits: {link}"

FOLLOW-UP EMAIL (DAY 3 OF 14)

"One question I get a lot: {common question}. Short answer: {answer}. Happy to go through yours whenever suits: {link}"

TOOLS, THREE WAYS

START FREE	ALL-IN-ONE	DONE FOR YOU
Cal.com / Calendly confirmations and email reminders • MailerLite or Brevo (free plans) for the 14-day follow-up.	GoHighLevel, HubSpot sequences (paid). Text reminders are usually a paid add-on.	Reminders, no-show rebooking and follow-up that stop automatically when someone books or replies.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Reminders with no rebook link, so a clash becomes a no-show.
- "Just checking in" follow-ups with nothing useful in them.
- Follow-up that keeps going after they've replied.

IF YOU ONLY DO ONE THING

Add a rebook link to your reminder emails.

THE NUMBER TO WATCH

Show rate (calls attended ÷ calls booked)

RECOMMENDED TARGET

8 in 10 or better.

IN YOUR INDUSTRY

DESIGN STUDIOS	PROPERTY	ACADEMIES	AGENCIES
Send two or three photos of similar finished projects in the confirmation.	Confirm viewing details and parking; most no-shows are logistics.	A short video from a current student before the interview lifts attendance.	Send a 3-question pre-call form; people who fill it in show up.

FROM A REAL BUILD

A live-music brand in Brooklyn now has its campaigns lined up automatically for every event. Two simple emails to people who'd stopped opening brought in $250 in two or three days, before anything else had changed.

HOW THE AUTOMATION RUNS

WHEN Call booked → **THEN** Confirmation, then reminders 24h + 1h before → **THEN** No-show: rebook link within 15 min → **RESULT** Never booked: 14 days of useful emails

THEY SAY YES

05 Conversion

"Loved the proposal", then weeks of chasing

THE LEAK

The call goes well. You send the proposal. "Love it, let me talk to my partner." Then three weeks of polite chasing for a signature and a deposit.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Your number: proposals a month ____ × the share that go quiet ____% × what a client is worth $____ = **$____ a month**, plus the weeks of cash flow you wait on the ones that do sign.

THE RESEARCH

Invoices with an online "pay" option get paid 1.4 times faster (Intuit QuickBooks data, 2025).

TEST YOURSELF TODAY

Count the steps between a client saying "yes" and the deposit landing in your account. Separate documents, emails and bank transfers each count as a step.

YOUR SCORE

0	PDF by email, separate contract, bank transfer details sent later.
1	Proposal and e-signature online, payment separate.
2	One link: read, accept, sign and pay the deposit in one sitting; you're alerted when it's opened; follow-ups on day 2, 5 and 10.

DO THIS

01 Send the proposal **within 24—48 hours** of the call.

02 Put proposal → accept → agreement → deposit **behind one link.**

03 Get an **alert when they open it**, and follow up while they're reading.

04 **No response:** follow up day 2, day 5 (answer the most common objection), day 10 (close the loop).

05 Offer **instalments** on large projects.

05

CONVERSION · CONTINUED

Copy it, tool it, measure it

SCRIPTS TO COPY

SENDING THE PROPOSAL

"Hi {first name}, here's everything we talked about: {link}. You can read it, sign and pay the deposit in one go. If anything's unclear, reply here or grab 15 minutes: {link}"

DAY 2

"Did the proposal make sense? Happy to walk through any part of it."

DAY 5

"A question people often ask at this stage is {objection}. Here's how we handle it: {answer}."

DAY 10

"I'll hold your slot until {date}. After that I'll free it up for the next project. No pressure either way."

TOOLS, THREE WAYS

START FREE	ALL-IN-ONE	DONE FOR YOU
Stripe Payment Links (no monthly fee; card fees apply) + a free e-sign tool • Google Docs proposal.	HoneyBook / Dubsado (proposal, contract and invoice in one), PandaDoc (open alerts, e-sign and payment).	Proposal, agreement and deposit in one branded flow, with the deposit triggering onboarding (layer 06).

COMMON MISTAKES

- Waiting a week to send the proposal.
- Making the client ask how to pay.
- Proposals that list tasks but not the outcome they're buying.

IF YOU ONLY DO ONE THING

Add a "pay deposit" link to the bottom of your next proposal.

THE NUMBER TO WATCH

Days from proposal sent to deposit paid

RECOMMENDED TARGET

Under 7 days.

IN YOUR INDUSTRY

DESIGN STUDIOS	PROPERTY	ACADEMIES	AGENCIES
Split design fee and procurement deposit clearly; confusion here stalls signatures.	Use agreement-before-payment with the acceptance recorded (time, date).	Instalment plans lift enrolment on higher-priced programmes.	Offer two or three packages instead of one quote.

FROM A REAL BUILD

A studio-hire business took bookings by message. We rebuilt it so customers book and pay online, with discount codes and offers the owners change themselves.

HOW THE AUTOMATION RUNS

WHEN Proposal sent → **THEN** Opened: alert to you → **THEN** No reply: follow-ups day 2, 5, 10 → **RESULT** Signed and deposit paid in one link

06

THE WORK STARTS

Fulfilment

Onboarding by hand, "what happens next?"

THE LEAK

They've paid, which is the best moment in the whole relationship. Then they wait two days for a contract, a welcome email and a "next steps" message someone has to remember to write.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Your number: hours your team spends per new client on onboarding and "where are we?" messages ____ × new clients a month ____ = ____ **hours a month** not spent on the work.

THE RESEARCH

About 60% of work time goes on "work about work": chasing status, updates and switching apps (Asana Anatomy of Work Index, 2021).

TEST YOURSELF TODAY

Write down every step between "paid" and "project started". Circle the ones that only happen because someone remembers.

YOUR SCORE

0	Every onboarding step is manual; clients regularly ask what's next.
1	Templates exist, but someone still sends each one.
2	The deposit triggers contract, welcome, portal access and next steps automatically; weekly updates go out on their own; approvals live in one place.

DO THIS

01 **The deposit is the trigger.** The moment it lands, automatically:

02 send the signed **contract** copy and a **welcome email** with the timeline,

03 give access to a **client portal** (files, approvals, updates in one place),

04 send a **"what happens next"** checklist and a kickoff booking link.

05 **Every week:** a short update: done this week, next week, what we need from you.

06 **Approvals** recorded in the portal, not in email threads.

06

FULFILMENT • CONTINUED

Copy it, tool it, measure it

SCRIPTS TO COPY

WELCOME

"Welcome aboard, {first name}! Here's your project space: {portal link}. Three things happen next: 1) {step}, 2) {step}, 3) {step}. Your kickoff call: {link}. Anything at all, reply here."

WEEKLY UPDATE

"This week: {done}. Next week: {plan}. From you: {request, or 'nothing this week'}."

TOOLS, THREE WAYS

START FREE	ALL-IN-ONE	DONE FOR YOU
Stripe + Zapier / Make to trigger the emails • a shared Google Drive folder or Notion page as a simple portal.	HoneyBook / Dubsado (workflows and client portal), SuiteDash.	A branded portal connected to payments, so paying the deposit starts everything.

COMMON MISTAKES

- The welcome email arriving days after payment.
- Files spread across WhatsApp, email and Drive.
- No regular update, so the client fills the silence with worry.

IF YOU ONLY DO ONE THING

Write your welcome email once and send it the same day every deposit lands.

THE NUMBER TO WATCH

Time from deposit to welcome

RECOMMENDED TARGET

Under 10 minutes, automatically.

IN YOUR INDUSTRY

DESIGN STUDIOS	PROPERTY	ACADEMIES	AGENCIES
Put mood boards and selections in the portal for approval.	Document checklists with clear owners and dates.	Day-one access to the course, community and first task.	The kickoff questionnaire goes out with the welcome, not on the call.

FROM A REAL BUILD

For a design studio, paying the deposit now sends the booking link, contract, portal access and next steps on its own. The founder, after testing it herself: "I've had a play around and just know you are never leaving."

HOW THE AUTOMATION RUNS

WHEN Deposit paid → **THEN** Contract copy + welcome email → **THEN** Portal access + next steps → **RESULT** Weekly update, every Friday

07

THE JOB IS DONE

Retention

The handover ends with an invoice

THE LEAK

The project's done and the client is the happiest they'll ever be with you. Most businesses mark that moment with a final invoice and silence.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Your number: clients finished a year ____ × the share who'd refer or rebook if asked (try 1 in 5) ____ × what a client is worth $____ = **$____ a year left on the table.**

THE RESEARCH

Keeping 5% more customers has been linked to profit increases of 25% to 95% (Bain & Company research, via HBR). 92% of people trust recommendations from people they know over advertising (Nielsen, 2012).

TEST YOURSELF TODAY

Look at your last three finished clients. Did each one get asked for a review? For a referral? Have you spoken to them since?

YOUR SCORE

0	No reviews or referrals asked for, no contact after the final invoice.
1	Sometimes asked, by hand, when someone remembers.
2	Handover pack, review ask at the high point, referral ask two weeks later, check-ins at 3—6 and 12 months, all automatic.

DO THIS

01 **At handover:** a wrap-up pack: what was done, how to look after it, who to call.

02 **At the high point** (reveal, final walkthrough): a review request with a one-tap link.

03 **Two weeks later:** a referral ask, with a thank-you for referrals.

04 **3—6 months:** a check-in. **12 months:** an anniversary note.

05 **Past clients:** a short update 3—4 times a year.

07

RETENTION · CONTINUED

Copy it, tool it, measure it

SCRIPTS TO COPY

REVIEW ASK (SAME DAY AS HANDOVER)

"It's been a joy working on {project}. If you're happy, a quick Google review helps more than you'd think: {link}. It takes about a minute."

REFERRAL ASK (2 WEEKS LATER)

"Hope you're settling in with {result}. If anyone you know is thinking about something similar, I'd love an introduction. Just reply with their name, or forward them this: {link}."

ANNIVERSARY

"A year ago today we finished {project}. How's it holding up? If anything needs a tweak, I'm here."

TOOLS, THREE WAYS

START FREE	ALL-IN-ONE	DONE FOR YOU
Your Google review link (from Google Business Profile) · email automations in MailerLite or Brevo.	GoHighLevel reputation tools, NiceJob or Birdeye (paid review platforms).	The final payment triggers the handover pack, review ask and referral sequence automatically.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Asking for a review three months later, when the feeling has faded.
- Only asking clients you're sure are happy (Google doesn't allow that, see page 22).
- A referral ask with no easy way to pass it on.

IF YOU ONLY DO ONE THING

Send your Google review link to your last three finished clients this week.

THE NUMBER TO WATCH

Share of finished clients asked for a review and a referral

RECOMMENDED TARGET

Every one of them.

IN YOUR INDUSTRY

DESIGN STUDIOS	PROPERTY	ACADEMIES	AGENCIES
Professional photos at the reveal double as portfolio and review prompt.	Anniversary notes keep you in mind for the next purchase or sale.	Graduates are your best ambassadors; ask for a story, not just a star rating.	A quarterly results summary keeps retainers and referrals coming.

FROM A REAL BUILD

For the design studio, the final payment now triggers the review request and referral information automatically.

HOW THE AUTOMATION RUNS

WHEN
Final payment

→

THEN
Handover pack + review ask

→

THEN
2 weeks later: referral ask

→

RESULT
12 months later: anniversary note

ACROSS ALL OF IT

08 Attribution

No idea which source brings the big clients

THE LEAK

Ask most owners which source brought their three biggest clients this year and they'll guess. So time and money go to whatever feels busiest, not whatever actually pays.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Example: 20 enquiries a month × $30k a client = $600k of decisions made each month on a guess. Your number: monthly marketing spend + hours ____ that go to channels that have never produced a client.

TEST YOURSELF TODAY

Write down your three biggest clients this year and where each one first found you. Can you prove it, or are you guessing?

YOUR SCORE

0	No record of where enquiries come from.
1	"How did you hear about us?" asked sometimes, never tied to revenue.
2	Every enquiry records its source, carried to the invoice; a monthly report shows enquiries, wins and revenue by source.

DO THIS

01 **Every enquiry records its source:** the tag from layer 01 plus a required "How did you hear about us?" question.

02 That source is **saved on the client record** in your pipeline.

03 When they pay, the source goes **on the invoice or deal.**

04 **Monthly:** a simple report of enquiries, wins and revenue by source.

05 Put more into the top two sources and cut what never produces a client.

08

ATTRIBUTION • CONTINUED

Copy it, tool it, measure it

SCRIPTS TO COPY

FORM QUESTION

"How did you hear about us?" → Instagram • Google • Referral (who?) • Saw our work • Other.

MONTHLY REPORT (4 LINES)

Enquiries by source • Won by source • Revenue by source • One decision for next month.

TOOLS, THREE WAYS

START FREE	ALL-IN-ONE	DONE FOR YOU
Source tags + Google Analytics 4 • a "Source" field in your CRM or sheet • Looker Studio (free) for the report.	HubSpot, GoHighLevel reporting.	One dashboard that ties enquiries, payments and campaigns together, so the answer is on one screen.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Counting clicks and likes instead of clients and revenue.
- An optional "how did you hear" question that nobody fills in.
- Losing the source somewhere between the enquiry and the invoice.

IF YOU ONLY DO ONE THING

Make "How did you hear about us?" a required question on your form.

THE NUMBER TO WATCH

Revenue by source

RECOMMENDED TARGET

You can name your best source with evidence.

IN YOUR INDUSTRY

DESIGN STUDIOS	PROPERTY	ACADEMIES	AGENCIES
Track referrals by who referred; your best referrers deserve a thank-you.	Portals, referrals and direct enquiries convert very differently; measure each.	Track which content brings applicants who actually enrol.	Track source through to signed retainer value, not just leads.

FROM A REAL BUILD

For the Brooklyn live-music brand, every ticket now shows whether it came from Instagram, email or ads. The summer flagship I planned the campaigns for grossed $26,736, and they could see where the sales came from.

HOW THE AUTOMATION RUNS

WHEN Enquiry arrives with a source tag → **THEN** Source saved on the client record → **THEN** Carried to the deal and invoice → **RESULT** Monthly report: revenue by source

ADD IT UP

Your scorecard

LAYER	0	1	2	YOUR SCORE
01 Attention	No clear next step	Some channels	One tagged link everywhere	☐
02 Capture	Next day +	Same day, manual	Instant + personal in 5 min	☐
03 Pipeline	Inboxes + memory	List, not kept up	One list, owners, weekly review	☐
04 Follow-up	Nothing	Reminders only	Reminders + rebook + 14-day	☐
05 Conversion	PDF + transfer	E-sign, pay separate	One link to sign and pay	☐
06 Fulfilment	All manual	Templates, sent by hand	Deposit triggers everything	☐
07 Retention	Never asked	Sometimes	Always, automatically	☐
08 Attribution	No record	Asked sometimes	Source to revenue, monthly	☐
Total				**/16**

0—6: most of your growth is leaking out; start with layers 02 and 03. **7—11:** the basics are there; the money is in the layers scoring 0 or 1. **12—16:** you're ahead of most; tighten the weakest layer and measure.

Your lowest layer is where to start. Reply to the email this came with and tell me your score.

PRIORITISE

Effort vs impact: what to fix first

FIX	LAYER	SETUP TIME	COST	IMPACT
Automatic reply with booking link	02	30 min	Free	High
Required "How did you hear about us?"	08	10 min	Free	Medium (grows over time)
Rebook link in reminders	04	15 min	Free	Medium
One link, one next step	01	1 hour	Free	Medium
Review link to last 3 clients	07	15 min	Free	Medium
One pipeline with stages and owners	03	Half a day	Free—paid	High
Proposal + sign + pay in one link	05	1—2 days	Paid tools	High
Deposit-triggered onboarding + portal	06	Days to weeks	Paid / built	High
Revenue-by-source dashboard	**08**	**Days to weeks**	**Paid / built**	**High**

The quick wins are worth doing this week. The high-impact ones take longer, and that's usually where it's worth having it built properly.

ONE LAYER AT A TIME

The 30-day plan

- **Week 1: stop the bleeding (Capture + Pipeline).** Automatic reply with booking link • phone alerts • one list with stages and owners • "How did you hear about us?" required.
- **Week 2: don't lose the yes (Follow-up + Conversion).** Confirmation and reminders with rebook links • 14-day follow-up for people who don't book • proposals out within 48 hours with a pay-deposit link.
- **Week 3: deliver like a premium business (Fulfilment).** Welcome email the same day as the deposit • simple client portal • weekly update template.
- **Week 4: turn clients into the next clients (Retention + Attribution + Attention).** Review and referral asks • past-client list • one link everywhere, tagged • first monthly report by source.

THE FINE PRINT

Staying on the right side of the rules (US)

Not legal advice, but the basics every business should know:

- **Texts (TCPA):** you need a person's permission before sending them marketing or automated texts. Add a consent checkbox to your form.
- **Marketing emails (CAN-SPAM):** include a working unsubscribe link and a physical postal address, and honour unsubscribes promptly.
- **Reviews:** Google's policies don't allow "review gating", meaning only asking clients you know are happy. Ask everyone. Never offer payment or discounts in exchange for reviews.
- **Call recording:** some states require everyone on the call to agree. Ask at the start.

PLAIN WORDS

Glossary

- **CRM:** a shared list of every enquiry and client, with where they are and what happens next.
- **Pipeline:** the stages an enquiry moves through, from New to Won or Lost.
- **Source tag (UTM):** a short label added to a link (`?src=instagram`) so you know where a visitor came from.
- **Automation:** something that happens on its own when something else happens ("deposit paid → welcome email sent").
- **Trigger:** the event that starts an automation.
- **Webhook:** how one app tells another app that something happened, instantly.
- **Client portal:** one private page per client for files, updates and approvals.
- **Show rate:** booked calls attended ÷ calls booked.
- **Attribution:** knowing which source produced which client and how much they spent.

NEXT STEP

Want it built for you?

Everything in this map works if you set it up yourself, and many owners do. If you'd rather have it connected end to end, in your own accounts, with someone who's done it before, that's what I do.

I've built this for a design studio (deposit to portal to referral), a Brooklyn live-music brand (campaigns, attribution, one dashboard), a subscription platform (payments and payouts that run themselves) and a cleaning company (book and pay online, no phone call).

Start with the free audit: 30 minutes, we go through your scorecard together and I show you where I'd start. naunas.co.uk/audit

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